

CHAPTER - 1

INTRODUCTION

Literature is the art of using language to express ideas, emotions and stories that reflect the complexities of the human experience, often creating lasting cultural and intellectual value. Literature serves as a mirror to society, reflecting cultural values, historical events and personal emotions, while also exploring universal themes such as love, conflict, identity, and morality. The importance of literature extends beyond entertainment it challenges the mind, evokes deep emotions, and fosters empathy by allowing readers to experience different perspectives. Through its ability to convey complex ideas and emotions, literature has long been a tool for both personal reflection and societal change. From ancient epics to modern novels, literature plays a pivotal role in shaping cultures, influencing thought, and preserving stories across generations.

Literature often involves a high level of imagination and creativity. Writers create fictional worlds, characters and scenarios that may not exist, providing readers with new perspectives and experiences. Through imagination, literature can explore the abstract, the fantastical and the philosophical, offering new ways of thinking. Literature often addresses specific cultures or time periods many works have universal relevance.

Literature can transcend time and place, making it accessible to readers across different backgrounds. It is a unique and dynamic form of artistic expression that involves the creative use of language, exploration of deep themes and the ability to evoke strong emotions. It serves as a mirror to society, offering both personal and collective insights, often with the aim of entertaining, educating, or provoking thought. It also captures the essence of different cultures preserving

traditions languages and historical contexts for future generations. It reflects societal values and experiences.

Canadian literature, the body of written works produced by Canadians. Reflecting the country's dual origin and its official bilingualism, the literature of Canada can be split into two major divisions English and French. The first writers of English in Canada were visitors explorers travellers and British officers and their wives who recorded their impressions of British North America in charts, diaries, journals, and letters. These foundational documents of journeys and settlements presage the documentary tradition in Canadian literature in which geography, history and arduous voyages of exploration and discovery represent the quest for a myth of origins and for a personal and national identity.

Canadian literature is intertwined with the socio-political developments that shaped the nation. The earliest examples consisted of explorers journals, chronicling geographic discoveries of the vast landscape. It encompasses a wide range of genres, including fiction, poetry, drama, and short stories, often focusing on themes of identity, cultural conflict, and the human experience Alexander Mackenzie's documentation of westward routes. With the arrival of United Empire Loyalists in the late eighteenth century works portrayed immigrant experiences of settling in a new environment under colonial subjugation. The early twentieth century witnessed experimentations with form and styles through Modernism. Writers delved into psychological and philosophical themes on existence and challenged orthodox styles. Post-Second World War period saw debates around nationalism and cultural policy. Promulgation of multiculturalism in 1971 acknowledged the diversity of ethnicities. Authors highlighted the plurality of voices through characters with immigrant origins.

Contemporary Canadian literature confidently asserts a decolonized vision, representing plural senses of belonging through genres like graphic novels, and emphasizing inclusivity. Ongoing reconciliation with Indigenous communities is a major contemporary influence. Canadian literature is a diverse and vibrant field reflecting the country's vast cultural geographical and linguistic diversity. It includes works in both English and French, along with Indigenous languages and covers a wide range of themes such as identity, colonial history, multiculturalism, the relationship with nature and the experience of living in a vast, often isoidentity landscape. The literature emphasizes the importance of nature and the environment with Canada's vast often harsh landscape playing a central role. Writers like Margaret Atwood, Michael Ondaatje, and Thomas King, have gained international recognition contributing to a global understanding of Canadian society. In essence, Canadian literature offers a nuanced portrayal of the nation's evolving identity shaped by its diverse communities and the challenges of its past and present.

The word novel derives from the Italian novella for new , news , or short story of something new', itself from the Latin novella, a singular noun use of the neuter plural of novellus, diminutive of novus, meaning 'new'. According to Margaret Doody, the novel has 'a continuous and comprehensive history about two thousand years', with its origins in the Ancient Greek and Roman novel, Medieval Chivalric romance, and the tradition of the Italian Renaissance novella. A novel, an invented prose narrative of considerable length and a certain complexity that deals imaginatively with human experience, usually through a connected sequence of events involving a group of persons in a specific setting. Within its broad framework, the genre of the novel has encompassed an extensive range of types and styles picaresque, epistolary, Gothic, romantic, realist, historical to name only some of the more important ones.

The novel is a genre of fiction and fiction may be defined as the art or craft of contriving through the written word representations of human life that instruct or divert or both. The ancient romance form was revived by Romanticism, in the historical romances of Walter Scott and the Gothic novel. Some novelists including Nathaniel Hawthorne, Herman Melville, Ann Radcliffe, and John Cowper Powys, preferred the term 'romance'. Such 'romances' should not be confused with the genre fiction romance novel, which focuses on romantic love. M. H. Abrams and Walter Scott have argued that a novel is a fiction narrative that displays a realistic depiction of the state of a society while the romance encompasses any fictitious narrative that emphasizes marvellous or uncommon incidents. Works of fiction that include marvellous or uncommon incidents are also commonly called novels, including Mary Shelley's *Frankenstein*, J. R. R. Tolkien's *The Lord of the Rings*, and Harper Lee's *To Kill a Mockingbird*.

Speculative fiction is a broad literary genre that encompasses stories set in worlds or situations that are different from our own, often involving elements like fantasy, science fiction, alternate history, or supernatural phenomena. The term is used to describe works that speculate on 'what if' scenarios, such as imagining the future, exploring alternate realities, or considering the impact of magical or technological advancements. It allows for creativity and exploration of possibilities beyond the limitations of the real world. Science fiction, a form of fiction that deals principally with the impact of actual or imagined science upon society or individuals.

The term science fiction was popularized, if not invented, in the 1920s by one of the genre's principal advocates, the American publisher Hugo Gernsback. Science fiction is a modern genre. By the beginning of the twentieth century, an array of standard science fiction 'sets' had developed around certain themes, among them space travel, robots, alien beings, and time travel. Science fiction writers often seek out new scientific and technical developments to prognosticate freely the

techno-social changes that will shock the readers sense of cultural propriety and expand their consciousness.

Early forms of speculative fiction can be traced back to ancient myths, religious texts, and stories that imagined worlds, events, or beings beyond the known reality. These early works didn't necessarily fit the modern definition of speculative fiction, but they laid the foundation for many of the themes and ideas explored in later genres like science fiction and fantasy. These early works helped to establish the roots of speculative fiction where writers began imagining worlds beyond the immediate and known often exploring the consequences of new knowledge supernatural elements or alternate realities. While they might not fit the exact mold of modern science fiction, fantasy, or other speculative genres, they were the first steps toward imagining different possibilities, much like modern speculative fiction does today.

Contemporary Canadian literature features a diverse array of authors who explore themes like identity, culture, history, and the natural landscape. Some notable Canadian authors of the present day include Alice Munro Born in 1931 in Wingham, Ontario. She is one of Canada's most celebrated authors, known for her mastery of the short story. Munro's stories frequently revolve around ordinary people, often focusing on women's lives and the intricate emotional landscapes they navigate. Her well-known works include *Dance of happy shades* 1968 , *Dear life* 2012 .Alice Munro received numerous awards and honours over her career, including the Nobel Prize in Literature in 2013, for her 'mastery of the contemporary short story'.

Margaret Atwood Born on November 18, 1939, in Ottawa, Canada, she has written numerous novels, short stories and poetry collection. She is perhaps best known for her novels that explore complex themes such as gender, power, identity, and social structures. Social injustice, environmental destruction, and the impact of technology and culture on individuals. One of her

most famous works are *The Handmaid*(1985), a dystopian novel, *Oryx and Crake* 2003), a speculative fiction novel. Throughout her career, Atwood has received numerous prestigious awards, including the Booker Prize, the Giller Prize, and the Governor General's Award.

Yann Martel Born on June 25, 1963, in Spain to Canadian parents, Martel grew up in a variety of countries, including Costa Rica, France, and Mexico, before settling in Canada. This international upbringing has influenced his writing, which often blends different cultural perspectives and explores themes of faith, survival, and the meaning of life. Martel's works *Life Of Pie* 2002, *The High Mountain of Portugal* 2016 .He received numerous award Booker prize award for his work.

Anne Michaels she was born in Toronto in 1958 and has published both poetry and prose. Anne Michaels' works often explore the relationship between memory and identity, as well as the effects of war and displacement. The novel blend's themes of loss, memory and identity with a poetic, fragmented narrative structure. Michaels is also known for her poetry collections, such as *Fugitive pieces* 1996. He was highly acclaimed, winning the Giller Prize and the Trillium Book Award, and it has been translated into several languages.

The context of Canadian literature, this theme can manifest in various ways, often tied to the intellectual and cultural climate of the time. Canadian writers may use rationalism to explore issues of identity, colonialism, and nation-building, frequently questioning the role of reason in shaping individual and collective experience. Rationalism in Canadian literature is its contrast with more intuitive or emotional approaches to understanding the world, such as those tied to Indigenous traditions or romanticized views of the land. Rationalism in Canadian literature serves as a means of examining not just the intellectual forces shaping the nation, but also the underlying philosophical debates around identity, power, and cultural development.

Indigenous experience it explores issues of colonization, displacement, cultural preservation, identity, resilience, and the ongoing impacts of systemic oppression faced by Indigenous communities. The theme of Indigenous experience in Canadian literature invites reflection on Canada's colonial past and present, promoting understanding, reconciliation, and a broader recognition of Indigenous peoples' rights and contributions to Canadian society.

The story's protagonist, Snowman, reflects Biotechnology on a world where powerful corporations manipulate genetic modification for profit. This includes creating genetically modified creatures, like the Crakers humans modified to be more 'perfect' and other animals with specific traits. The novel critiques the ethical implications of such Biotechnology, where human desire for control over nature and evolution leads to unintended and destructive consequences. For instance, genetic manipulation results in the creation of monstrous creatures, like the genetically altered pigs, which ultimately become part of a disastrous cycle leading to ecological collapse.

Canadian literature, reflecting the nation's complex history of European colonization and its aftermath. Much of Canada's early literature focused on the experiences of settlers, the struggles of Indigenous peoples and the tensions between colonial powers such as the French and British and the native populations. The theme of colonialism continues to prompt reflection on Canada's past and present, encouraging dialogue about reconciliation, sovereignty, and the complexities of national identity.

Margaret Atwood is a renowned Canadian author, poet, literary critic, and activist, known for her contributions to literature across various genres. Born on November 18, 1939, in Ottawa. When she was seven, her family moved to Toronto but continued to spend the warmer months in the remote northern areas of Ontario and Quebec, where her father, an entomologist and zoology professor, studied tree-eating insects. Atwood's fascination with the Canadian wilderness, which

is present in so much of her writing, dates from this period. She was eleven before she attended school on a full-time basis. The novel contains numerous allusions to literature, mythology, and culture. For example The biblical parallels in the story of Crake as a god-like creator and the Crakers as his designed 'Edenic' species. Snowman's role resembles a prophet or guardian of the Crakers, highlighting themes of faith and storytelling.

The fragmented narrative mirrors the fractured world Snowman inhabits. This technique reflects the chaos and disorientation following the apocalypse, drawing readers into Snowman's psyche. Exploration of Language is central to the novel, particularly in Snowman's role as a storyteller for the Craker's. The evolution and loss of language symbolize the degradation of human culture and identity, while Snowman's storytelling reflects the human need to create meaning.

She received her Bachelor's degree from Victoria College, part of the University of Toronto, in 1961. Upon the recommendation of her mentor, Northrop Frye, she decided to pursue a graduate degree at Radcliffe College, which joined Harvard University while Atwood was studying there In 1962, she earned her master's degree, and although she stayed at Harvard intermittently over the next several years, she left the program before completing her Ph.D. By 1967, she was already becoming famous as a writer.

While studying in Boston, she published her first collection of poetry, *The Circle Game* 1966, which was awarded the prestigious Governor General award. Atwood gained international fame with her dystopian novel *The Handmaid's Tale* 1985, which has become a modern classic and was adapted into a successful television series. Other notable works include *Oryx and Crake* 2003, *The Blind Assassin* 2000, and *Alias Grace* 1996, the latter of which won the Booker Prize.

Atwood is recognized for her innovative storytelling, blending speculative fiction with social commentary, and her ability to craft complex characters and intricate narratives.

Oryx and Crake is a dystopian novel by Canadian author Margaret Atwood, first published in 2003. The story is set in a post-apocalyptic world and follows Snowman, the novel's protagonist, as he reflects on his past and the events that led to the downfall of humanity. Snowman lives in a barren, ruined landscape, with the remnants of a once-thriving civilization now largely wiped out. The novel alternates between Snowman's present and flashbacks to his life before the catastrophe. Through these flashbacks, we learn about his relationship with two central characters: Oryx, a mysterious woman with a tragic past, and Crake, a brilliant but morally ambiguous scientist. Crake's controversial genetic engineering experiments play a key role in the novel's unfolding disaster, as he creates a new, 'superior' species of humans, known as the Crakers, in an attempt to eradicate the flaws he perceives in the human race.

Oryx and Crake explores themes of bioengineering, environmental destruction, the ethics of scientific advancement, and the potential dangers of unchecked technological progress. It is the first book in Atwood's *Madd Adam trilogy*, which delves deeper into the world and characters introduced in this novel.

The first chapter highlights the concept of literature, genre of novel, Canadian literature, author introduction and her few notable works and at last about short summary of my novel oryx and crake.

The second chapter is going to reveal about the story of oryx and crake and enclose with the Devaluation of humanities.

The third chapter is going to reveal about the story of Oryx and crake and enclose with the Human degradation.

The conclusion chapter is highlights the review of other author and also some suggestion for the further budding researcher.

CHAPTER -2

DEVALUATION OF HUMANITIES

The devaluation of humanities refers to the declining value and importance assigned to humanities fields, science Languages e.g., English, history, philosophy Arts e.g., music, theater, visual arts Social sciences e.g., sociology, anthropology, psychology and Cultural studies. The perceived value and importance of humanities subjects like literature, history, philosophy, and art are declining, leading to reduced funding, fewer students choosing humanities courses, and a general perception that they are less relevant today. Oryx and Crake by Margaret Atwood, the devaluation of the humanities is explored within the context of a dystopian world dominated by corporate interests, technological advancements, and bioengineering. In the novel, the humanities fields of study focused on human culture, ethics, and the arts are largely overshadowed by the drive for scientific progress and profit.

The character of Snowman represents a product of this devaluation, having grown up in an environment where the humanities were seen as irrelevant, and more practical, technical skills

were prioritized. The humanities, which once explored human experiences, ethics, art, and philosophy, are sidelined and deemed irrelevant in a world obsessed with technological progress and consumerism. This devaluation is seen in the portrayal of the protagonist, Snowman, who recalls a time when subjects like literature and philosophy were undervalued and replaced by specialized, profit-driven studies. The consequences of this shift are profound, as it contributes to a society where individuals are disconnected from deeper moral and existential questions, leading to ecological destruction and the dehumanization of individuals.

The society in the novel places little value on the questions of meaning, morality, and human experience, which are often explored through the humanities. Instead, there's a focus on scientific innovation at the expense of ethical considerations. The Economic and Technological Dominance as technology and the economy continue to dominate modern society, disciplines that don't have a clear or immediate economic payoff are often overlooked or underfunded. This includes areas like philosophy, literature, and history, which are traditionally seen as fostering critical thinking, ethical reflection, and cultural understanding. Cultural and Social Impact of humanities are often criticized for being abstract or irrelevant to addressing immediate societal issues, but they are essential for helping us understand human experience, culture, values, and the complexities of the world. Their devaluation can lead to a diminished sense of empathy and ethical grounding in society.

Oryx and Crake by Margaret Atwood, there is a clear theme surrounding the devaluation of the humanities, which reflects broader societal shifts within the novel's dystopian world. The protagonist, Snowman, recalls a time when he and others lived in a world driven by commercialism and scientific progress, while culture, humanistic values, and arts were neglected or ignored. The world Snowman describes is heavily controlled by corporations, particularly the biotech company

Organic Farms, which focuses on genetic engineering and corporate profit. The humanities, which traditionally emphasize human values, creativity, and intellectual inquiry, have become sidelined in favour of more utilitarian fields such as science and technology. This devaluation is visible in Snowman's memories of his education and society's general indifference to humanistic pursuits, as they are overshadowed by the desire for technological advancement and economic success.

This societal shift also speaks to the novel's critique of an over-reliance on technology and the loss of empathy and moral considerations that the humanities often foster. Atwood uses Snowman's reflections to illustrate how the focus on profit-driven science and the neglect of broader human concerns have led to the collapse of a balanced, ethical society. The chapter sets up the novel's central tension between technological advancement and the importance of humanistic thought in shaping a just and sustainable world.

One of the most striking examples of the devaluation of the humanities is the focus on genetic modification, where human life is manipulated in a way that disregards ethical concerns. The characters, particularly Crake, view humanity as something that can be improved and engineered for efficiency, devoid of emotional, philosophical, or cultural complexity. This approach places scientific progress and technological advancement above moral and philosophical inquiry, which are key components of the humanities. The Loss of Art and culture in this novel reflects a world where art, literature, and culture have lost their importance. In the society depicted in *Oryx and Crake*, there is little to no appreciation for the arts, history, or human connections beyond what is useful for the survival of the corporate system. The humanities, which are traditionally seen as avenues for exploring human experience, creativity, and society, have become irrelevant in a world focused on practicality and profit.

They had to be burned he said to keep it from spreading what is a disease a disease is

like when you have a cough said his mother If I have a cough will I be burned up most likely said this his father turning over the page yes said jimmy sniffing leave daddy alone said his mother daddy is thinking that is what they pay him for he does not have time for you right now(OAC :22).

Snowman, who has survived a catastrophe, revisits his memories of the pre-apocalyptic society. The theme of devaluation of the humanities is highlighted through his recollections of his upbringing and the educational environment he and others were subjected to. In this society, the emphasis was placed heavily on science, technology, and corporate-driven progress, while subjects related to the humanities arts, literature, philosophy were relegated to secondary importance. Snowman's own experiences in the educational system reveal that the sciences were prioritized, and the humanities were often viewed as unnecessary or trivial. This is seen in the treatment of the subjects he studied, such as the arts and literature, which were overshadowed by the cutting-edge, profit-driven developments in genetic engineering and biotechnologies.

Atwood uses the fictional world of Oryx and Crake to comment on how societies in pursuit of scientific advancements can lose sight of values that the humanities represent ethics, morality, and human connection. The disregard for these subjects contributes to the creation of a society that places too much trust in technological progress, with little regard for its social or ethical consequences. This shift, in part, leads to the catastrophic events that unfold in the novel. Snowman recalls his life before the collapse, he reflects on the way education was structured in this dystopian world. While the focus in schools and universities was overwhelmingly on science, technology, and corporate-driven knowledge, the humanities were treated as secondary, even unnecessary. These fields were increasingly ignored, and as a result, people were disconnected

from the broader ethical and moral implications of their actions, particularly when it came to the advancements in biotechnology and genetic engineering.

The devaluation of the humanities is tied to the broader societal shift toward commodification and utilitarianism. Snowman's recollections of the educational system and the societal values of the time show how people were encouraged to pursue careers in lucrative, scientific fields, while the arts and humanities were seen as impractical and irrelevant. This disregard for the humanities contributes to a society in which ethical concerns and human empathy are neglected in favor of profit-driven progress, leading to the catastrophic events that unfold in the novel. The contrast between scientific advancement and the neglect of the humanities becomes even clearer, as Snowman grapples with the consequences of living in a world where human values and intellectual pursuits outside of science are undervalued.

That would be less wasteful as it took a lot of food and care to grow a pigoons a great deal of investment money had gone into Organinc farms stuff it says snowman do it yourself enlightenment handbook nirvanas for halfwits though he has the nagging feeling that he may well have written this gem himself in happier days naturally oh, so much happier (OAC :26).

The society in *Oryx and Crake* reflects Atwood's warning about the dangers of prioritizing technological progress at the expense of humanistic thinking, which plays a key role in understanding and managing the ethical consequences of such advancements. The dystopian world where science and technology have overtaken the importance of humanistic values and subjects like philosophy, ethics, and the arts In Snowman's memories, the educational system and societal

structure reflect a world where scientific knowledge, particularly in biotechnology, is revered above all else.

The humanities, which are traditionally focused on understanding human experiences, emotions, morality, and cultural expression, are devalued as unnecessary and even irrelevant in this world. People are trained to contribute to fields driven by corporate profit, such as genetic engineering, while ethical questions and the complexities of human existence are largely ignored. Snowman himself is a product of this system he studied science, and his life became intricately linked with the advancements made by corporations like Organinc.

He resisted her he pretended he did not understand even when he did he acted stupid but he did not want her to give up on him he wanted her to be brave to try her best with him to hammer away at the wall he did put up against her to keep on going I want to hear about the tiny cells he said whining as much as he dared I want to not today she said let is just go in(OAC:24).

The emphasis on technological and scientific progress has led to a world where individual thought, creativity, and moral reasoning, which the humanities often promote, are disregarded. In this context, the humanities are viewed as ‘soft’ subjects, perceived as less practical and less capable of contributing to the material success of the society. Through the experiences of Snowman and his relationship with characters like Crake, who embodies this utilitarian, science-driven mindset, Atwood highlights how the neglect of the humanities leads to a society that values efficiency and profit over the well-being of individuals and the preservation of human ethics. The

result is a morally bankrupt world, where technological advancements unchecked by the critical, ethical thinking that the humanities could have provided lead to catastrophic consequences.

Snowman reflects on the educational and societal systems that shaped his life, underscoring the growing neglect of the humanities in favor of science and technology. Throughout the novel, Atwood depicts a society dominated by large corporations that focus on profit and scientific advancement, particularly in the fields of genetic engineering and biotechnology. In this context, humanities subjects such as philosophy, literature, history, and the arts are seen as irrelevant or even impractical. This devaluation is clear in the way Snowman recalls his education, which was heavily centered on subjects like biology and molecular genetics, while more human-centered disciplines were either overlooked or dismissed. In Snowman's memories, he and his peers were encouraged to pursue careers that contributed directly to the corporate-driven, scientifically dominated world.

The emphasis on science and technology often left little room for critical thinking, empathy, or ethical consideration the very qualities that the humanities often promote. This neglect of humanistic values contributed to a society where moral questions about the consequences of scientific advancements were not seriously addressed. The character of Crake, who plays a central role in the story, embodies the dangers of this utilitarian, science-centered approach. Crake's vision for the world, which Snowman reflects on throughout the novel, is one where technological progress is prioritized without consideration for the complexities of human nature or ethical implications. This reflects a worldview in which the humanities, which could offer moral guidance and challenge the ethical ramifications of scientific endeavours, are completely disregarded. Atwood continues to critique the societal shift away from the humanities and the consequences of such devaluation.

Snowman's memories of his upbringing and education reveal a society that prioritized scientific innovation and profit-driven endeavour's, particularly in biotechnology and genetic engineering. The humanities arts, literature, philosophy, and ethics were seen as irrelevant and unimportant. Education was largely focused on fields that served the economic goals of powerful corporations, with less attention given to subjects that encouraged critical thinking about human values and societal well-being. This reflects a broader societal shift where intellectual pursuits concerned with the human experience, culture, and moral reflection were pushed aside to make way for utilitarian, science-based knowledge. The character of Crake, a key figure in the novel, represents the extreme manifestation of this attitude toward the humanities. Crake's worldview is deeply influenced by his training in science, and he holds a firm belief that human nature is flawed and that scientific intervention is the key to improving humanity.

Did you give him a dollar oryx had asked him when he told her about the knife no what
you need to give money when someone gives you a knife so the bad luck will not cut
I would not like it for you to be cut by the bad luck jimmy who told you that oh someone
said oryx someone played a big part in her life someone who jimmy hated him this
someone(OAC:42) .

Crake's vision, there is little room for the ethical complexities that the humanities might engage with. Instead, he advocates for a scientific, technocratic approach to solving human problems, one that disregards the moral considerations and philosophical questions that the humanities might raise. Atwood critiques a world that has become increasingly focused on technological advancement, with little regard for the humanistic values that could provide necessary checks and balances. In this context, the devaluation of the humanities contributes to the

dystopian collapse depicted in the novel. The lack of ethical consideration and moral reflection, which the humanities encourage, leads to catastrophic consequences, particularly in the unchecked manipulation of biology and the environment. To explore how the neglect of the humanities along with an overemphasis on science and technology has shaped the dystopian world of *Oryx and Crake*.

The humanities, which could have provided a moral and ethical framework, are shown to be essential for addressing the human cost of scientific progress, and their absence is one of the central factors contributing to the downfall of society. The educational system focused on technical skills that served corporate and scientific interests, with little attention given to critical thinking or moral reasoning that the humanities foster. Snowman's memories highlight the societal tendency to elevate science over human-centered disciplines, even though the rapid advancements in technology were shaping the world in ways that raised profound ethical questions. However, these questions were often ignored or dismissed, leaving no space for the type of ethical reflection the humanities. Crake, who is highly educated in science, holds a worldview that disregards the importance of human values and emotional considerations. Crake believes that human nature is inherently flawed and that science, particularly genetic engineering, can be used to improve humanity, eliminating what he sees as the imperfections that arise from human emotions, desires, and morality.

His approach is starkly utilitarian, with no apparent concern for the ethical implications of his actions. This reinforces the notion that the humanities, with their focus on the complexities of human experience and ethical reflection, could have offered essential insights into the moral consequences of such scientific endeavours'. Atwood uses Crake's actions, which drive much of the novel's plot, to critique a society that has neglected the humanities. The absence of ethical

frameworks from disciplines like philosophy and literature leads to the unchecked pursuit of scientific knowledge without consideration for its potential harms. The novel presents the dangers of a society where science and technology reign supreme, leaving humanistic inquiry behind, and where advancements are pursued without a thoughtful examination of their impact on humanity and the environment.

That you have thought up yet another way to rip off bunch of desperate people said

Jimmy mother in that new free voice god you are cynical no you are we can give people

hope at no skins prizes it is you hype your wares and take all their money and then they

run out of cash and it is no more treatment for them (OAC:64)

The humanities are seen as superfluous in the face of technological progress, highlighting the necessity of a balanced approach that integrates science with ethical considerations and humanistic thought. The devaluation of the humanities continues to be explored, deepening the critique of a society that prioritizes science, technology, and corporate interests over humanistic values. Snowman, the protagonist, reflects on his past and the society he once inhabited, where the humanities were increasingly disregarded in favour of fields that served the agendas of powerful corporations and the expansion of scientific knowledge. Subjects focused on human nature, emotions, and ethics, which are often central to the humanities, were marginalized. This neglect of the humanities had significant implications, as it meant that the ethical dilemmas raised by scientific progress were left largely unaddressed.

This novel exemplifies the consequences of this devaluation. Crake, with his unyielding focus on science and technology, represents the extreme version of a world that dismisses the value of humanistic inquiry. He embodies a mindset that views human flaws, such as emotional

attachment, empathy, and moral complexity, as obstacles to be eliminated through scientific intervention. In Crake's vision, the humanities are seen as irrelevant because they focus on the very aspects of human life that Crake believes need to be controlled or eradicated. Snowman's reflection is how to the neglect of the humanities contributed to the collapse of society. The lack of ethical inquiry, the absence of philosophical debate and the dismissal of human values left the world vulnerable to dangerous scientific practices and technological advancements that were pursued without consideration of their social, environmental and moral consequences.

Snowman's recollections reveal that in the society he once inhabited, the sciences particularly genetic engineering was viewed as paramount, while the humanities were regarded as unimportant and impractical. This neglect of human-centered fields reflects a broader cultural shift where profit-driven technological advancements took precedence over values rooted in human experience, morality and cultural expression. People in Snowman's world were trained to pursue careers that served corporate and scientific interests, often at the expense of critical thinking, empathy, and ethical considerations that are typically emphasized in the humanities. Crake, one of the novel's key figures, represents the extreme consequence of this neglect. Crake's worldview is grounded in science, particularly in genetic engineering, and he believes that the only way to improve humanity is through scientific intervention. He dismisses human emotions, cultural diversity, and ethical reflection as hindrances to human progress. His approach ruthless utilitarian and scientifically driven embodies the dangers of a society that has abandoned the humanities in favor of a narrow focus on technological and scientific control.

Then crake represents the extreme consequences of this devaluation. Crake's view of the world, shaped by his education in science and his belief in the power of biotechnology, is rooted in a utilitarian and mechanistic worldview. He dismisses the importance of emotions, ethical

concerns, and human flaws, which are core to the humanities. Crake's belief that science can improve humanity by eliminating what he views as its weakness emotions, imperfection, and moral ambiguity reflects a worldview that is devoid of the ethical inquiry and humanistic values that could have tempered such destructive ideas. In a world dominated by corporate and scientific interests, where technology and innovation are seen as the ultimate goals there is little room for the kind of moral reflection that could have questioned or restrained the technological developments that led to the collapse of society.

There is lack of critical thinking about the ethical implications of scientific advances contributed to the catastrophic results that Snowman now experiences in the post-apocalyptic world. The dangers of a society that prioritizes scientific progress without consideration for the ethical and philosophical implications of such advancements. The absence of the humanities leaves a vacuum where critical reflection, empathy, and moral responsibility should be leading to a world where unchecked scientific ambition wreaks havoc. Atwood's portrayal of the devaluation of the humanities serves as a warning about the dangers of overvaluing technology and science while neglecting the human-centered disciplines that are essential for fostering ethical, thoughtful progress.

The societal focus on biotechnology and profit-driven research stifled any meaningful discussion about the human condition, human rights, or the implications of genetic manipulation. The humanities, which typically encourage questioning and reflection on the deeper aspects of life, were seen as secondary to the practical, results-oriented pursuits of science and business. The technological progress is valued above humanistic thinking, showing how the lack of critical thought and ethical reflection led to the tragic consequences of the novel. The absence of the

humanities left individuals like Crake to pursue unchecked technological advancements, which ultimately resulted in societal collapse.

Through Snowman's reflections and the societal backdrop, Atwood underscores the importance of the humanities in maintaining a moral compass in the face of technological progress, warning against a world where science and profit are the only guiding principles. The idea that without the humanities to guide ethical thinking, technological and scientific developments can go unchecked. The lack of philosophical and ethical discourse surrounding biotechnology and genetic engineering allowed individuals like Crake to experiment with creating new life forms and altering humanity itself without considering the consequences.

Snowman's world is shaped by the consequences of neglecting humanistic education, which might have provided the necessary ethical framework to curb such reckless experimentation. So devaluing the humanities, contributes to the moral and ethical blindness that lead to its eventual downfall. The absence of disciplines that examine the deeper questions of human existence, society, and values leaves a vacuum where unchecked scientific progress, devoid of any moral consideration, can thrive leading to catastrophic consequences. Atwood reinforces the idea that the humanities are essential not only for understanding the human experience but also for ensuring that scientific progress serves humanity in a responsible and ethical manner.

The world of genetic engineering and biotechnological innovation in which Crake and others worked lacked the ethical frameworks that the humanities typically provide. Snowman's memories of how Crake approached life, the project of designing the Crakers, and his experiments reveal a disregard for the emotional and moral dimensions of human existence dimensions that the humanities explore. The society in which Snowman lived believed that the humanities were obsolete, but this abandonment resulted in a morally blind scientific agenda, one that ignored the

deeper human implications of manipulating life and technology. Without disciplines that encourage moral reflection critical thinking and ethical discourse, scientific progress becomes detached from the human experience and can lead to disastrous outcomes as exemplified by the collapse of Snowman's world.

The humanities were marginalized, seen as unnecessary in a world that believed progress could only be achieved through innovation in biotechnology, genetic engineering, and corporate capitalism. Snowman recalls the way Crake, a central figure in the novel, viewed the world. Crake's approach to life was grounded in science, and he actively dismissed the value of human emotions, ethical considerations, and moral reflection values that are often the core of humanistic thought. Crake believed that humanity's flaws, such as greed, jealousy, and violence, were inherent to human nature, and he saw the humanities as irrelevant to his goal of improving humanity.

Crake aimed to create a humanity human race, eradicating the emotional and ethical complexities that the humanities often explore. This reflects the destructive consequences of a world where ethical and moral concerns are dismissed in favor of scientific. The humanities could have provided, allowed Crake's vision to go unchallenged, leading to catastrophic consequences. The lack of reflection on the emotional and moral dimensions of human life allowed unchecked scientific experimentation and manipulation, particularly in the form of genetic engineering, which ultimately contributed to the downfall of the prioritization of science and technology over human values. By presenting a world in which the humanities are discarded in favor of utilitarian, profit-driven science, Atwood demonstrates how the lack of ethical and philosophical grounding can result in dangerous, dehumanizing consequences.

Snowman tell us please about the deeds of crake a story is what they want in exchange

for ever Slaughtered fish we'll I owe them snowman thinks God of bullshit fail me not

what part could you like to her to night he says in the beginning prompt a voice they are

fond of repetition they learn things by heart(OAC :117) .

Snowman's survival in the post-apocalyptic world, struggling to make sense of the ethical implications of Crake's actions, underscores the novel's central message the humanities are vital in grounding technological progress within a framework of moral responsibility and human empathy. Atwood uses this setting to critique real-world trends where corporate interests and technological advancements often overshadow the importance of the arts, philosophy, and humanistic studies. Through characters like Snowman formerly Jimmy , who remembers the cultural and intellectual richness of the past, the novel explores the consequences of this neglect and the impact on personal identity, morality, and society.

The devaluation of the humanities in *Oryx and Crake* highlights the dangers of a world where humanistic values are sidelined in favour of scientific and technological pursuits, leading to a loss of meaning and connection to humanity's broader ethical and philosophical concerns. Atwood critiques this shift, suggesting that the neglect of the humanities leads to a society that loses sight of its moral compass and humanity itself. The world in *Oryx and Crake* is governed by powerful biotech corporations that focus solely on scientific and technological progress for profit. In this society, the value of human life, ethical consideration, or cultural reflection takes a back seat to the corporate drive for innovation and economic gain.

The humanities, which often provide critical analysis of social issues, history, and ethics, are completely sidelined. Instead, the world focuses on genetic engineering, profit, and consumption, where people are reduced to consumers or products of corporate control. For example, Crake the

scientist responsible for the creation of the Crake's is portrayed as someone who has no interest in moral philosophy or the complexities of human society, focusing only on efficiency and biological perfection. One of the most notable manifestations of the devaluation of the humanities is the lack of ethical reflection in society. In the novel, scientific advancements, like genetic modification and the creation of new species such as the Craker's are carried out with little consideration for the social, ethical or moral consequences.

The absence of philosophical or ethical frameworks key components of the humanities leads to a dystopian future where scientific experiment are conducted without concern for the intrinsic value of human life or the natural world. Characters like Crake see human life as something to be perfected or controlled, with no room for empathy or cultural context. The devaluation of the humanities is intricately tied to the novel's critique of a society that prioritizes science and technology without any grounding in moral or cultural reflection. Atwood warns of a future where the pursuit of profit and scientific control eclipses the values and questions central to human life, such as empathy, ethical responsibility, and cultural understanding. The neglect of the humanities contributes to a loss of meaning and humanity itself, highlighting the dangers of a world that ignores the critical role of the arts, philosophy, and social sciences in shaping a just and thoughtful society.

The result is a society that has advanced technologically but has become ethically bankrupt and emotionally disconnected, as seen through the devastating consequences of Crake's experiments and the loss of human diversity. Atwood warns against the potential dangers of neglecting the humanities in favor of unchecked technological development. The devaluation of the humanities in the novel acts as a critique of modern society's tendency to prioritize science and progress without considering the broader humanistic and ethical dimensions of such

advancements. The theme concludes with a grim reflection on what happens when the human spirit, creativity and moral consideration are sidelined in favor of cold, utilitarian science and profit-driven motives.

HUMAN DEGRADATION

Human degradation refers to the process or state of being degraded, dehumanized, or reduced to a lower level of dignity, worth, or well-being. It involves the erosion or loss of human rights, dignity, and respect, often resulting in physical, emotional, or psychological harm. Human degradation is a central theme, explored through both the physical decay of humanity and the moral decline that accompanies the advancements in genetic engineering and technological progress. The novel presents a dystopian world where humans, in their pursuit of scientific and genetic experimentation have lost their ethical compass. Snowman the protagonist reflects on how humans have become obsessed with consumerism, self-indulgence and the exploitation of nature and other species leading to their eventual downfall. The story reveals that the human race's disregard for environmental sustainability and their prioritization of profit over morality led to a catastrophic event that nearly wiped-out humanity.

Human degradation is a complex issue, often perpetuated by systemic injustices, power imbalances, and social inequalities. Addressing these issues requires a multifaceted approach, involving policy changes, education, and community engagement. Snowman's thoughts about the degradation of humanity are directly tied to the actions of Crake a brilliant but morally detached scientist. Crake's experiments in genetic engineering and his creation of the crake's a genetically modified species, are intended to replace humans, whom he views as morally corrupt and self-destructive. Crake believes that humanity is inherently flawed, and his solution is to eliminate it and replace it with a more perfect species. The Craker's, while devoid of human flaws such as violence and greed, also lack the complexity and depth of humanity, which underscores the novel's exploration of how the loss of human traits can be seen as both a degradation and a form of 'purification.' Through these elements, Oryx and Crake critiques the dangers of unchecked

technological advancements, the ethical and moral decline of society, and the self-destructive tendencies that lead to human degradation. It highlights how humanity's attempt to improve itself through manipulation of nature ultimately brings about its own ruin. Genetic Manipulation and the Loss of Humanity

Why are not you making the locks for the doors any more said jimmy because I wanted to stay with you she said looking over the top of jimmy head and puffing on her cigarette what about the pigeons said jimmy alarmed the microbes will get into them he did not want his animal pals to burst open like the infected cells other people are in charge of that now said his mother she did not seem to care at all (OAC:34) .

The novel critiques humanity's over reach in genetic engineering as Corporations create bioengineered animals such as pigeons and rakunks and genetically modified humans Crakers, disregarding ethical concerns. This reflects how scientific advancement, when driven by profit and hubris, leads to the loss of human dignity and identity. Moral Decay and the Dehumanization of Society in Society in the novel is divided between the privileged corporate elite and the impoverished masses. Entertainment revolves around child exploitation, live executions, and violent pornography, illustrating moral collapse. Characters like Crake, who sees life as a biological experiment, embody this dehumanization.

Environmental Destruction and Its Consequences this novel presents a world where climate change, pollution, and resource depletion have left much of the Earth uninhabitable. This destruction is linked to corporate greed and human short sightedness, showing how humanity's disregard for nature ultimately leads to its downfall. Social Inequality and Exploitation Atwood

highlights extreme economic disparity: while the elite live in secure compounds, the poor suffer in lawless pleeblands. Oryx, a key character, represents the exploitation of the vulnerable, as she is trafficked and abused from a young age.

The Failure of Human Empathy the protagonist, Snowman is one of the few who struggles with guilt and nostalgia for lost humanity. However, even he is complicit in the system's decline, showing how apathy and selfishness contribute to society's degradation. Snowman, the protagonist reflecting on his current desolate situation. He is living in a post-apocalyptic world, surrounded by the ruins of human civilization. The text presents a stark vision of human degradation, both physically and morally.

Snowman's environment is an eerie wasteland, and he appears to be one of the last survivors of a catastrophic event. The scientific hubris, the fragility of humanity, and the consequences of reckless genetic engineering. Snowman's survival is precarious, and there is a sense of loss and hopelessness that permeates his thoughts. His reflection on the events leading to the collapse of society unfolds throughout the novel but sets the stage for exploring the darker aspects of human behavior and the destructive impact of unchecked technological advancements.

Snowman's present-day survival and flashbacks to his earlier life when he was a part of a society that was rapidly descending into moral and environmental decay. One of the key elements that highlights human degradation is the portrayal of the society Snowman once lived in. It is a world where scientific and technological advances have spiraled out of control, driven by corporations with little regard for the broader ethical consequences. People are increasingly disconnected from nature and the real world, living in isolated, controlled environments like the Compounds, where they are shielded from the environmental destruction occurring outside.

Snowman's reflections on his former life with Crake and Oryx emphasize the moral corruption and emptiness of human existence. Crake, whose scientific ambitions drive much of the novel's plot, sees humans as flawed creatures tainted by emotions, greed, and violence. He views genetic manipulation as a way to create a better, more perfect species, free from the destructive traits that define humanity. In contrast, Oryx, a mysterious and enigmatic figure, represents a different side of human degradation, one shaped by exploitation, trauma, and commodification. Her background in child trafficking and sexual exploitation speaks to the deep moral rot in society. It is a world where people are numbed to their own moral failings, living in a society that prioritizes profit, consumerism, and technological progress at the expense of human well-being and environmental sustainability. This touches on the idea that the loss of true connection and empathy among humans is one of the central aspects of their downfall.

The exploration of human degradation by showing how both individual and societal moral decay, along with the unchecked pursuit of scientific advancement, contributed to the collapse of humanity. Snowman's reflections on his past life set the stage for understanding how the degradation of human values and environmental destruction are intertwined. Human degradation is the portrayal of the societal systems that existed before the downfall. The world in which Snowman and Crake lived was dominated by corporate control and scientific experimentation, where profit was prioritized over ethics, and human beings were reduced to mere commodities. The corporations not only controlled the biotechnological developments but also had a hand in the genetic manipulation of life itself.

This commodification of life, where genetic engineering was used to create more efficient or ideal beings highlights the moral decay in society as humans became increasingly detached from nature and the consequences of their action.

What people want is perfection said the man in themselves but they need the steps to it
to be pointed out said the women in a simple order said the man with encouragement said
he women and a positive attitude they like to hear about the before and the after said the
man it is the art of the art of the possible but with no guarantees of course (OAC:288).

Snowman reflects on the disturbing nature of the world he lived in, where humans were no longer seen as an intricate species with emotional depth and complexity but rather as resources to be exploited or modified. The genetic modifications created creatures like the Craker's, genetically engineered beings meant to be the perfect replacement for humans free of the flaws that led to human violence, greed, and corruption. However, these genetically modified beings also represent a twisted form of purity, lacking the complexity and beauty of human emotions, which implies that even perfection, in Crake's eyes, is a form of degradation because it removes the very qualities that make humanity unique.

Snowman's interactions with Crake and Oryx in the past serve as a reflection of the moral degradation that defined the world. Oryx's past, involving her exploitation in the sex trade, reveals the darker side of human nature and the objectification and abuse that many endure in a society that thrives on exploitation. Her story is a stark example of human degradation through systemic abuse, highlighting how exploitation can shape and twist individuals, stripping them of agency and dignity. The Compound isolated from the outside world, living in sanitized, artificial environments where human relationships are shallow and governed by corporate interests. In this context, human

life becomes secondary to profit and control reinforcing the idea that the world Snowman lived in was one where humanity had degraded into something almost unrecognizable, driven by selfish desires and technological obsession.

The exploration of human degradation by illustrating how technological advancement unchecked corporate power and moral corruption led to the collapse of human society. This emphasizes the dehumanization of individuals and the way in which exploitation, both systemic and individual, contributed to the unravelling of humanity's ethical and social fabric. Snowman, reflecting on the downfall of humanity. Snowman, living in a post-apocalyptic world, is surrounded by the remnants of human civilization and is haunted by memories of the past. He remembers the time when humans were deeply involved in unethical scientific experiments and reckless consumption, leading to the collapse of society. Through his reflections, Atwood illustrates how humanity's hubris, driven by unchecked technological advancements and a disregard for moral boundaries, contributed to its own destruction.

The novel depicts human degradation both in the physical sense e.g., the mutation of people and the rise of new genetically modified species like the Craker's and in a moral sense, where the moral compass of humanity becomes increasingly warped in the pursuit of power, pleasure, and control over destruction. Atwood's portrayal of this degradation calls attention to the dangers of overstepping ethical limits in the name of progress, as well as the consequences of greed and selfishness.

No said crake he never made me do much of anything then what was the jimmy said

crake not everything has a point snowman has trouble thinking of crake as glen so

thoroughly has crake's later persona blotted out his earlier one (OAC:81).

The deep societal flaws and moral corruption that led to the downfall of humanity. Atwood continues to emphasize the destructive nature of unchecked scientific experimentation, corporate greed and exploitation of the environment. Snowman recalls the world before the apocalypse, where corporations like OrganInc and HelthWyzer conducted unethical genetic engineering, creating life forms like the genetically modified Crakers and experimenting with human genetics in pursuit of profit. Snowman's memories of the time leading up to the catastrophe reveal how society became increasingly disconnected from nature and morality. The human pursuit of power, comfort, and immortality led to the manipulation of life for commercial purposes, disregarding the potential consequences for both the environment and humanity itself. The consequences of this scientific .This would be really evil said Jimmy and corporate exploitation are seen in the degradation of human life both physically in the form of disease and genetic mutations and morally with the loss of empathy, compassion and ethical responsibility.

Atwood underscores the human tendency to push boundaries without considering the long-term impacts, suggesting that humanity's inability to balance innovation with moral responsibility contributed directly to its downfall. Snowman, as the sole survivor, embodies the consequences of this degradation, witnessing firsthand the destructive effects of humanity's arrogance and ignorance. Particularly through the lens of Snowman's memories of the pre-apocalyptic world. In this chapter we see further examples of humanity's moral and societal decay often tied to the exploitation of science and technology for selfish and short-sighted purposes. One of the key aspects of human degradation there is the further exploration of the commodification of life.

The corporations like Organic and the other biotech companies continue to push the boundaries of genetic engineering without regard for ethics or consequences. For example, the

creation of the Crake's genetically engineered humans meant to serve as a better version of humanity is a direct result of a flawed belief that scientific manipulation can improve upon nature. Snowman reflects on how Crake, the scientist responsible for the genetic modifications, viewed humanity as something that could be perfected or even replaced. In this context, humanity is seen as something inherently broken leading to its own degradation through the attempt to improve it artificial.

People are increasingly detached from each other and the natural world caught in a cycle of consumerism instant gratification and technological dependence. Snowman also recalls the pervasive feeling of existential emptiness that plagued society where people were disconnected from meaningful relationships and lived in a world where corporate interests often came before personal or environmental well-being. Human degradation through the choices made by characters and society as a whole showing how scientific hubris moral indifference and greed ultimately contributed to humanity's fall. Snowman, as the sole survivor reflects on how these societal flaws led to the collapse of the world as he knew it, illustrating the moral and physical decline of humankind in the face of unchecked technological progress.

Snowman's memories of life before the apocalypse, where humanity was increasingly disconnected from nature ethics and one another. One of the key aspects of human degradation in this chapter is the growing reliance on genetic modification and biotechnology, as seen through the work of Crake, Snowman's former friend. Crake's belief in the superiority of his genetically engineered creations, like the Craker's highlights the moral decline of society. He saw humanity as inherently flawed and believed that creating a perfect species would solve the problems of human violence, greed and environmental destruction. Crake's actions driven by this view are

emblematic of human degradation the attempt to play God and reshape life without consideration for the long-term consequences.

People were consumed by their desires for comfort, entertainment, and consumer goods, leading to a lack of meaningful connection and responsibility. The corporations, such as OrganInc and other biotech companies, exploited science for profit, often at the expense of ethics and humanity. This commodification of life, where humans were treated as resources for experimentation, further reflects the degradation of society and the loss of moral integrity.

Through Snowman's reflections, Atwood underscores how human degradation, both physical and moral, was driven by a disregard for the consequences of scientific advancements and a failure to recognize the importance of empathy, ethics and sustainability. It highlights the devastating results of unchecked technological experimentation and the exploitation of nature and human life. Focuses on the relationships and events that shaped Snowman's understanding of humanity's decline, including the growing moral and social decay, which is embodied in the characters around him, particularly Crake and Oryx. The idealistic but flawed notions of progress held by Crake and the more human, emotional connections that Snowman still clings to.

Crake's scientific work and worldview are characterized by a deep disregard for human complexity, viewing humans as a problem to be fixed. His obsession with genetic engineering and his creation of the Crakers represent a belief that humanity itself needs to be 'purified' or replaced entirely, which is a form of dehumanization seeing humans not as beings to be cared for or understood, but as experiments to be perfected.

They might hurt you by mistake said snowman as but it is not the ground hurts us you

when you fall on it but it is not ground wish to hurt us oryx has told us that the ground

is our friend it grows our food for us yes said snowman but crake made the ground hard otherwise we would not be able to walk on it took them a minute to work this one through then there was much nodding of heads (OAC:409) .

She is depicted as a victim of exploitation, having been trafficked and objectified throughout her life. Oryx, a figure of both innocence and experience, represents how human beings particularly women were commodified and degraded by societal structures. Her history is marked by the erosion of her personal autonomy and the loss of innocence, reflecting the broader degradation of human values in the world Snowman once inhabited. Additionally, Snowman himself reflects on his own complicity in the system that led to the degradation of humanity. While he questions Crake's motives, he also feels powerless in his ability to alter the course of events. The indifference of society, the corrupt corporate control, and the growing acceptance of unethical practices all point to a world where human degradation is normalized and even rationalized. The distortion of values for personal and scientific gain, and the emotional and moral disintegration of society. Snowman's introspection and his complex relationships with Crake and Oryx show how these forces culminated in the downfall of humanity, with technological and scientific arrogance playing a central role in the destruction of the natural world and human society.

Human condition before the apocalypse, highlighting how the pursuit of technological progress and genetic engineering led to a dehumanized, morally degraded world. Snowman, now the sole survivor, remembers how the society around him became increasingly detached from basic human values, replaced by the corporate-driven pursuit of profit, consumption and unethical scientific advancements. Crake, the central figure behind many of these changes, represents the idea of less human development in the sense that his approach to human development was not about nurturing

human potential or fostering emotional growth but about eradicating what he viewed as humanity's flaws. Crake's vision involved the creation of the Crakers, genetically modified beings who were designed to be free of human vices like violence, lust, and greed. In his quest to 'improve' humanity, Crake's vision paradoxically led to a stripping away of what made humans uniquely complex emotions, empathy, and morality. In this sense, there's less development of true humanity in Crake's vision, as the complexity of the human experience is reduced to a simplistic, idealized version.

Snowman reflects on the societal shift where people became more focused on superficial pleasures and consumerism, as biotechnology and corporations exploited and commodified life. This consumer-driven culture, devoid of ethical consideration and self-awareness, contributed to a world that was less human in the sense that it lacked depth meaning and compassion. The people of this world were disconnected from the natural world, disconnected from each other and increasingly alienated from their own humanity.

The idea of human development through the lens of corporate greed and technological control, suggesting that the pursuit of progress without moral or ethical boundaries leads to a less human society where empathy personal growth, and environmental responsibility are sacrificed for convenience profit and the illusion of perfection. The dangers of a one-dimensional approach to development highlighting how humanity's decline results from overreliance on science and technology without regard for the deeper aspects of human existence. Snowman's memories of the time before the apocalypse, revealing the consequences of humanity's overindulgence in technology and genetic experimentation. There is growing divide between the 'normal' people and the genetically modified individuals created by Crake.

Snowman recalls the increasing dehumanization of society, where genetic modification becomes the norm and ethical boundaries are increasingly disregarded. This focus on biotechnology is presented as a form of scientific hubris as corporations like OrganInc, manipulate life for profit and convenience without considering the long-term consequences for the planet or humanity itself.

The experimentation on both humans and animals highlights how the pursuit of perfection or advancements through genetic engineering leads to a loss of empathy, creating beings that are no longer fully human. Additionally, Snowman remembers how the societal values of consumerism, corporate control and exploitation caused the physical and emotional degradation of humanity. People were increasingly disconnected from the natural world, and their lives were ruled by corporate interests leading to widespread moral decay. There's a growing sense of detachment from the environment and from the consequences of actions which contributed to the degradation of society as a whole.

Would be those that cause lingering illnesses ideally that is for maximum profit the patient should either get well or die just before all of his or her money runs out it is a fine calculation this would be really evil said jimmy that's what my father thought said crake he knew jimmy really was paying attention now he found out that's how come they pushed him off bridge (OAC:248).

The effects of these societal changes on Snowman's own relationships and sense of self. His friendship with Crake is marked by the tension between Snowman's human vulnerabilities and Crake's cold, scientific worldview. Snowman's memory of Oryx also highlights how individuals

in this society were commodified and exploited, especially women, who were often treated as objects for sale and consumption. Oryx's own degradation, having been trafficked and used by powerful men, serves as a symbol of the loss of human dignity in this society. Human degradation by examining how the unchecked pursuit of scientific progress and profit leads to the breakdown of moral values, personal connections and the environment. The society in the novel has become a place where humanity itself is commodified, manipulated, and degraded, and the consequences of this mindset are felt by Snowman as the sole survivor in a post-apocalyptic world.

Human degradation in this chapter is the growing prevalence of genetic modification and the creation of bioengineered organisms. As Snowman recalls, Crake's work especially with the Crakers was an attempt to improve upon humanity by removing the flaws he believed were inherent in human nature, such as violence, sexual desire, and greed. However, this attempt at perfection highlights a deeper form of degradation Crake's vision of improvement involves eliminating complex human qualities in favor of a sanitized, emotionless existence.

The Crakers, designed to be docile and unthinking, represent a regression, as they are stripped of the very aspects that make humans human such as emotional depth, moral ambiguity, and the ability to form complex relationships. In this way, the genetic engineering efforts led to a loss of humanity, as Crake's creations were meant to exist without the rich often messy emotional lives that characterize human beings.

The world of Snowman remembers was one driven by consumerism and corporate greed where corporations like OrganInc dominated and people were consumed by materialism. This society had a growing disregard for the natural world with corporations exploiting both human beings and the environment for profit. Snowman recalls a world where personal connections were increasingly superficial and humanity was losing touch with its moral compass. The pursuit of

convenience, comfort and technological advancement came at the cost of ethical consideration and emotional fulfillment.

The Snowman's own reflections on the degradation of his friendships, particularly with Crake. While Crake's intellectual brilliance was unquestionable, his cold detachment from human emotion and his lack of empathy led him down a path of moral corruption. Snowman, in contrast, still retains traces of human emotion, such as love and guilt, which further emphasizes the contrast between the two characters and the loss of humanity that occurred as a result of Crake's worldview. Human degradation in *Oryx and Crake*, showing how the pursuit of scientific perfection and technological advancement when divorced from ethical considerations leads to a hollow and dehumanized society. Through Crake's actions and the societal collapse, Atwood illustrates how the failure to understand and nurture the complexities of human nature can result in the degradation of both individuals and entire civilizations.

Snowman's personal reflections on his relationship with *Oryx and Crake* reveal how human connections have deteriorated in a world where individuals are reduced to commodities or experiments. Oryx's story is marked by exploitation, highlighting the degradation of human dignity and autonomy in the context of systemic abuse and commercialization. She was trafficked and objectified, reflecting the way in which human lives were commodified for profit. It continues to critique the dangers of blind technological advancement and the failure to recognize the importance of empathy, ethics, and human complexity. The world Snowman remembers was one where humanity's deep flaws were attempted to be eradicated through genetic engineering, but in doing so, the most human aspects of life—emotion, love, complexity—were lost.

Snowman reflects on how humanity became increasingly alienated from nature and from each other. People were driven by consumerism, instant gratification, and the technological

advancements that allowed them to live in isolation, disconnected from the world around them. This detachment from nature, from ethics, and from any sense of collective responsibility led to the decline of moral values. Corporations, such as OrganInc operated without regard for the long-term consequences of their actions, manipulating genes and exploiting natural resources in pursuit of profit. This exploitations are both environment and of human lives of further contributed to the degradation of society, creating a world where people were treated as commodities rather than individuals.

Furthermore, Snowman's relationship with Crake and Oryx highlights the emotional and psychological degradation of human beings. Snowman, even as he reflects on his past, recognizes that both he and Crake were emotionally stunted in different ways. Crake, despite his intellectual genius, lacked empathy and emotional connection, viewing human beings as flawed and needing to be 'fixed'. Oryx, who had experienced a lifetime of exploitation and objectification, represents a different form of degradation one in which the commodification of human beings stripped away her agency and dignity. These corporations, driven by greed and a lack of moral responsibility, represent the degradation of human values. Rather than using science to improve life in a meaningful, ethical way, they used it to exploit and control, often without regard for the long-term consequences for humanity or the planet.

Snowman's personal reflections also contribute to the theme of degradation. As he remembers his past, he acknowledges the emotional isolation that characterized his relationship with Crake and Oryx. Snowman's own complicity in the larger forces of degradation is evident; though he was critical of Crake's actions, he was still complicit in the development of the Crakers and in the system that led to the world's collapse. His own emotional numbness and inability to act decisively reflect the broader apathy of a society that prioritized convenience and progress over ethical

responsibility. Atwood deepens her critique of human degradation, showing how the overreach of scientific and technological advancements without ethical consideration leads to the erosion of the very qualities that make us human. The relentless pursuit of control and perfection through genetic engineering results in a sterile and emotionally barren world, where people are alienated from each other and from their own humanity.

They are roasting something meat of some kind a rakunk yes there is a tail over there
on the ground they must have shot it the poor creature snowman has not smelled roast
meat for so long is that why his eyes are watering he is shivering now he is feverish
now it is hard to know oh jimmy you were so funny do not let me down (OAC:432).

The consequences of treating life as a commodity and the dangers of a society that values progress over empathy, connection, and moral responsibility. The corporations, such as OrganInc and HelthWyzer, engaged in genetic experimentation and environmental exploitation without regard for long-term consequences. Life became commodified, and human beings were reduced to mere subjects of experimentation for profit, further degrading the moral fabric of society. On a personal level, Snowman's reflections on his relationships with Crake and Oryx illustrate how human connections have also deteriorated in a world that values profit over empathy and emotional connection. Oryx, who had been trafficked and exploited, represents the commodification of human life, particularly women, in a world that no longer values dignity or autonomy. Her story embodies the degradation of humanity's moral compass, where individuals are seen as objects to be used and discarded.

Snowman's introspection reveals his own emotional degradation as well. He is a survivor, but he is also disconnected and isolated, unable to connect meaningfully with the world around him.

His sense of guilt and loss, as well as his inability to save or protect those he loved, reflect the moral and emotional disintegration that characterizes his existence in the post-apocalyptic world. His survival is a hollow one, as he contemplates the collapse of humanity, both physically and morally. Delves into the physical, emotional, and moral decay that marked the pre-apocalyptic world, ultimately leading to the extinction of humanity as Snowman knew it. Genetic engineering and the exploitation of nature ultimately led to humanity's degradation both in terms of the loss of essential human qualities and the collapse of the social and moral structures that once held civilization together.

Collapse of Civilization by the end, the remnants of human civilization are in ruins. The world is overrun by bioengineered creatures, and the few remaining humans are struggling to survive. This suggests that humanity, through its own arrogance and recklessness, has brought about its downfall. The Rise of the Craker's, who were designed to be free of violence, jealousy, and hierarchical thinking, now roam the earth. Their existence implies that Crake's vision of an engineered better species has replaced the flawed, self-destructive human race. Snowman's Moral Dilemma the novel ends ambiguously with Snowman encountering a group of human survivors. He is left to decide whether to approach them peacefully or eliminate them as a threat to the Crakers. His hesitation reflects the last remnants of human moral conflict whether to embrace a new way of life or repeat the cycles of violence and destruction.

Human degradations are starkly evident as Snowman contemplates the ruin that Crake's experiments have wrought on humanity. Then the paints a grim picture of how the human race, in its pursuit of progress and scientific achievement, has caused its own downfall. Crake's creation of the Crakers, a genetically modified species designed to be free of the flaws of humanity such as greed, jealousy, and violence, illustrates an effort to escape the darker aspects of human nature.

However, the result is an unnatural, sterile existence where any form of human emotion or complexity is absent.

Through this novel human degradation is underscored by the fact that Snowman, one of the last remaining humans, is left to reflect on the consequences of human actions. His loneliness and despair reveal the emptiness of a world stripped of genuine human connection and meaningful life. In the end, the degradation is not only physical but moral and emotional, as humanity's desire to control and manipulate nature leads to its own extinction, leaving behind a hollow world.

CHAPTER -4

CONCLUSION

Margaret Atwood's *Oryx and Crake* employs several sophisticated narrative techniques that contribute to its complexity and depth. Here are the key narrative techniques used in the novel:

Non-linear Narrative Structure Atwood employs a non-linear narrative, moving back and forth between the protagonist Snowman's formerly Jimmy's present and his past. This technique allows the reader to uncover the dystopian world gradually, creating suspense and a sense of mystery.

Present Timeline Snowman's survival in a post-apocalyptic world where he interacts with the Crakers and struggles with isolation and scarcity.

Past Timeline Jimmy's life before the collapse, exploring his childhood, his relationship with *Oryx and Crake*, and the events leading to the apocalypse.

The story alternates between intimate, personal narratives Snowman's relationships, inner struggles and larger, global narratives the rise of genetic engineering, corporate dominance, and ecological destruction. This juxtaposition helps readers understand the interconnectedness of

individual and societal actions. Snowman serves as an unreliable narrator. His memories are fragmented, subjective, and occasionally contradictory, reflecting his psychological state and the challenges of piecing together the past after a cataclysmic event. This technique adds ambiguity, encouraging readers to question the accuracy of his account.

Atwood uses foreshadowing especially in Snowman's reflections on his past. Subtle hints about the dystopian collapse and the roles of *Oryx and Crake* build tension and anticipation, keeping readers engaged. Imagery and Symbolism The novel is rich in vivid imagery and symbolism. For instance, The Craker's Represent humanity's potential to be 'perfected' through genetic engineering, contrasting natural evolution with artificial manipulation. The Environment: The deteriorating natural world symbolizes the consequences of humanity's greed and disregard for ecological balance. Snowman's Name: Reflects his fragility and isolation in a hostile world, much like a snowman in the sun. Atwood employs satire to critique corporate greed, unchecked scientific experimentation, and consumer culture. The names of corporations e.g., HelthWyzer, Rejoov Essene and the absurdity of products like Chickie Nobs highlight the grotesque extremes of capitalism.

Oryx and Crake by Margaret Atwood employs a variety of literary devices that contribute to the depth of its storytelling. Here are some of the key devices used in the novel

Atwood references various mythological, religious, and literary themes throughout the novel. For example, Crake's name itself is an allusion to the crane's bird, symbolizing extinction and the harsh future Crake envisions. Additionally, Oryx's character has echoes of mythological figures, embodying the duality of victim and seductress. She also uses symbols to deepen the narrative. The genetically engineered creatures like the Crakers symbolize the consequences of human hubris

and the dangers of manipulating nature. The Snowman, as Snowman is the last human, symbolizes both the remnants of the past world and the fragile survival of humanity.

The novel set in a dystopian world, where the environmental collapse and corporate greed have led to the downfall of humanity. This setting creates an atmosphere of bleakness, alienation, and anxiety, exploring the consequences of unchecked scientific experimentation. The novel often contrasts the pristine, controlled world of the corporations with the chaotic, deteriorating world outside. This emphasizes the divide between the privileged and the underprivileged, as well as the contrasting ideologies of Crake and Snowman. Snowman's narration sometimes drifts into a stream-of-consciousness style, reflecting his unstable emotional state. This technique gives readers insight into his fragmented thoughts and memories, creating a sense of immediacy and emotional depth. There is a significant amount of irony in 'Oryx and Crake' especially concerning Crake's vision of utopia. His belief in creating a perfect, disease-free world leads to the unintended consequence of wiping out humanity. The irony lies in the fact that Crake's solution to human problems is ultimately more destructive.

The narrative structure of *Oryx and Crake* shifts between Snowman's present-day survival and flashbacks to his past, particularly his relationships with Crake and Oryx. This technique adds layers to the story, revealing key character motivations and the world's gradual descent into chaos. Atwood uses characterization to highlight the moral complexities of the main characters. Snowman, Crake and Oryx all embody different aspects of human nature rationalism, idealism, and survivalism which is explored throughout the novel. The Craker's themselves serve as a metaphor for both the hope and the danger inherent in human attempts to control nature. Crake's vision of creating a perfect species is a metaphor for the dangers of scientific hubris and the ethical

concerns surrounding genetic engineering. The novel can be read as an allegory of human greed, environmental destruction, and the consequences of tampering with nature.

Atwood critiques humanity's arrogance in believing that technological and genetic advances can solve all problems, ignoring the complexities and risks involved. *Oryx and Crake* by Margaret Atwood is a dystopian novel that explores themes of genetic engineering, humanity's moral compass, and the consequences of playing god. The story follows Snowman, the protagonist, who is living in a post-apocalyptic world, reflecting on his past relationships with two significant figures: Oryx, an enigmatic woman, and Crake, a brilliant but disturbing scientist. Atwood's writing is both lyrical and chilling, drawing readers into a world that feels eerily plausible, considering the rapid advancements in biotechnology. The novel delves into the ethical dilemmas of genetic manipulation and corporate greed, examining how these elements can lead to the destruction of humanity.

Atwood masterfully builds a narrative that is both introspective and suspenseful, blending science fiction with philosophical questions. Atwood introduces a highly stratified society, where corporate powers control not only technology but also human biology. The creation of the 'Crakers' a genetically modified species, adds an eerie layer to the plot, symbolizing both the promise and peril of scientific advancement. *Oryx and Crake* is a thought-provoking and unsettling exploration of Scientific hubris and the unintended consequences of unchecked technological progress. The significance of this novel interpreted as a warning about the potential dangers of manipulating nature and the pursuit of profit at the expense of moral and ecological responsibility. Atwood also examines themes of isolation, human desire, and the consequences of creating a world where moral boundaries become increasingly blurred in the face of technological advancement.

The novel challenges readers to consider the ethical implications of scientific innovation and its potential to reshape the future in unforeseen and often tragic . Atwood critiques the reckless manipulation of genetic engineering and biotechnology. Through the creation of the Craker's a genetically engineered species, and the tragic outcomes that follow, she reflects on how such advancements might lead to unintended consequences. Corporate Control and Environmental Collapse The novel also addresses the dominance of corporations in shaping society, especially in relation to biotechnological experimentation. Atwood warns about the potential for corporate monopolies to drive humanity toward ecological ruin and social inequality. Human Nature and Ethics the novel delves into the complexities of human nature, questioning what makes people human, especially in the context of ethics and morality.

Oryx, and Crake each grapple with their understanding of humanity, morality, and the impact of their choices. Isolation and Alienation Snowman, the protagonist, is isolated in a post-apocalyptic world, and his reflections throughout the novel highlight the loneliness and alienation that can arise from both technological advancements and societal breakdowns. Environmental Degradation: The novel portrays a dystopian world ravaged by environmental destruction. Atwood critiques humanity's exploitation of natural resources and the devastating effects of climate change, offering a cautionary tale about ecological collapse. In *Oryx and Crake*, Margaret Atwood conveys a powerful message about the dangers of human hubris, especially in relation to biotechnology and genetic engineering. Atwood warns about the potential consequences of unchecked scientific experimentation, where the pursuit of progress and profit can lead to irreversible harm. She also explores environmental degradation, corporate control and the ethics of genetic manipulation.

The novel serves as a cautionary tale about humanity's tendency to play god with nature without fully considering the moral, environmental, and societal implications. Atwood suggests that while technology and science have immense potential, they must be wielded with care and responsibility, as their misuse can lead to catastrophic outcomes, as seen in the dystopian world of *Oryx and Crake*. Ultimately, Atwood's message is a reflection on the fragility of human existence, the consequences of isolation and detachment from nature, and the need for ethical consideration in the face of scientific advancement.

In *Oryx and Crake*, Margaret Atwood conveys several messages to society, urging readers to reflect on critical issues that affect the future of humanity. Atwood warns against the reckless pursuit of scientific advancement, especially in biotechnology and genetic engineering. Through the creation of genetically modified organisms and the manipulation of life itself, the novel emphasizes that tampering with nature without considering the ethical, moral, and long-term consequences can have disastrous effects on society and the environment. Corporate Greed and Exploitation the novel critiques the growing power of corporations and their control over scientific research, technology, and the environment.

Atwood paints a dystopian world where profit-driven motives lead to the degradation of society and the environment. Through her novel she made an impact on humans have had on the planet, with themes of ecological collapse and environmental degradation. Atwood underscores the urgency of addressing climate change, deforestation, pollution, and other environmental crises. The novel suggests that if society does not take immediate and responsible action, humanity might face irreversible consequence advance Ethical Responsibility in *Oryx and Crake* stresses the importance of taking ethical responsibility for our actions, especially regarding the use of technology.

The novel raises the morality of genetic modification and the value of human life, encouraging readers to consider the broader implications of technological advancement. The story delves into the isolation of its characters, particularly Snowman, and explores the idea of what it means to be human. Atwood examines the destructive effects of detachment from nature, society, and even one's own emotions. This can be interpreted as a reflection on the alienation people may feel in a rapidly advancing, technology-driven world.

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